



Technical Session Moderator Guidelines

IDUG assigns a moderator to each presentation. The moderator's core responsibility is to welcome the speaker, confirm that introductory comments are accurate, and ensure the speaker is comfortable with all procedures and logistics.

Prior to the Actual Presentation

- Contact the speaker ahead of time to:
 - Ask whether they'd like to be introduced by you. If so, review their biographical information, which can be accessed in the IDUG app when provided.
 - Review presentation content so you can anticipate and moderate questions.
 - Confirm whether they'd prefer to take questions during or after the presentation.
- Arrange a final, brief meeting with the speaker — either at least 10 minutes before the presentation starts, or at the Speaker/Moderator Orientation session.

Before the Session Starts

- Pick up your moderator package from the IDUG registration desk and bring it with you to the presentation. The package includes:
 - Moderator Review Sheet
 - Session Evaluation Forms
- Test the audio-visual equipment (microphone, projector, lighting, etc.) with the speaker.
- Agree with the speaker on when questions may be asked (during or after the presentation) and confirm you'll signal them when five minutes remain before Q&A should start.
- If the session is being recorded, confirm that recording is allowed. If it is not, please notify a staff member or CPC volunteer before the session begins so that we can signal our A/V team to stop.
- Ensure Session Evaluation Forms are made available to attendees.
- Direct attendees to available seats and ensure all seats are used if the room is filled. If the room is at capacity, locate IDUG staff so that they may post "session closed" signage.

As the Session Begins

- Briefly introduce yourself and share the session number and title (ex. A11: Db2 is Amazing).
- Ask attendees to silence their mobile phones.
- Stress the importance of completing and returning the Session Evaluation Forms. They may be returned to you at the end of the session or delivered to the registration desk.
- Briefly introduce the speaker if agreed to.

During the Presentation

- Remain in the room for the entire session.
- Count attendees at the start of the session and again at the halfway point; record both numbers on the Moderator Review Sheet.
- Monitor audibility — signal the speaker if they need to speak up or adjust their microphone.
- Give time signals:
 - **Two hands** = 10 minutes remaining
 - **One hand** = 5 minutes remaining
 - **Both arms raised** = time is up
- If the speaker doesn't repeat a question, ask them to do so, especially if the session is being recorded. Signal the speaker if they miss a raised question from an attendee.
- Assist with logistical issues (equipment failure, lighting, audio, room temperature, etc.).
- Discreetly intervene if the speaker starts to "sell" products or services.

At the Conclusion of the Presentation

- Thank the speaker and the audience.
- Remind attendees to take their personal belongings.
- Reiterate the importance of completing and returning the Session Evaluation Form with the correct session code.
- Collect the evaluation forms and return them along with your completed Moderator Review Sheet and insert all materials into the moderator package. Return all materials to the designated area – see IDUG Registration with questions.

THANK YOU FOR MODERATING!